After typing these commands and following the prompts, Node.js will be installed.

VERIFYING THE INSTALLATION

You can verify that Node.js and NPM are installed correctly by typing the following two commands:

```
> node --version
> npm --version
```

You should see a version number for each tool. The samples in this book were run using Node.js version 0.10.29 and NPM version 1.4.14.

> **NOTE** Some Linux versions have a program called `node`. If you type `node --version` and nothing happens, you're probably running into this conflict. In this case, Node.js should be mapped to `nodejs`. Try typing `nodejs --version` instead.

If there is an issue with your install, visit the support at the Node.js homepage at http://nodejs.org. You can also learn more about installing Node.js on various platforms at https://github.com/joyent/node/wiki/Installing-Node.js-via-package-manager.

B.1.2 Express

The sample server is implemented using a web application framework called Express. Express simplifies the process of building web servers on Node.js by providing middleware that handles common web server operations. *Middleware* is a term used to describe functions inserted into the web server–processing pipeline that can act on the HTTP request or HTTP response. These functions are termed middleware because they sit in the middle of the incoming request and the actual code that processes the request. For example, Express has middleware pieces to handle common web server functionality such as authentication, compression, and cookie sessions. Figure B.6 shows how a request passes through pieces of middleware in Express.

You certainly don't have to use Express (or any web application framework for that matter), but it makes things easier by taking care of the grunt work of setting up a web server. This allows you to focus on the details of adding CORS support to the server. You can learn more about Express at http://expressjs.com.

You can use NPM (which was installed previously) to install Express. The installation instructions are the same for all OSes. To install Express, open up a terminal window in the location you wish to install to and type `npm install express`. That should be all you have to do! You can verify that Node.js and Express are installed

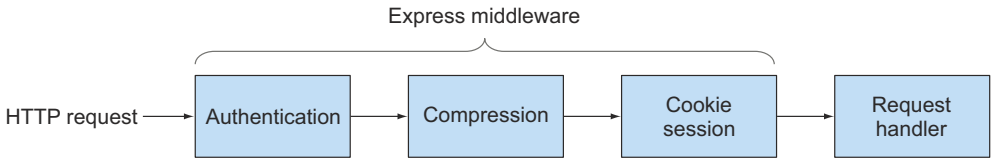


Figure B.6 An Express server with three middleware components